Study Materials: Qualtrics Survey Converted to PDF

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Survey ID: SV_dcdYhRXVG6jPrDL

This document shows the survey twice, across Part 1 & Part 2

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Part 1: the survey as one random participant would have seen it	**2–52**
Part 2: the full survey with all variations, including validation, randomization rules, js code, etc.	**54–156**

Note on appearance. The survey's visual style (its Qualtrics theme) is not contained in the .qsf file (universities often have custom branded Qualtrics themes that can impact appearance of a survey in a way that cannot be reproduced by QSF2PDF nor any program which runs outside of the originating institution). Fonts, colors, logos, and other styling therefore need not match what participants saw. The content, order, and logic of the survey do come from the .qsf file.

Part 1: the survey as one random participant would have seen it

-- Screen #1 --

Consent to Participate in a Research Study
Pacific Lutheran University

Title of Study: The effect of mind wandering and text difficulty on reading comprehension: A replication study.
Investigators: Alexis Herion and Cammy Widman, senior undergraduate students
Introduction

- You are being asked to be in a research study conducted at Pacific Lutheran University in Psychology.
- You were selected to participate because you are at least 18 years old AND:
  - You are a PLU student with a SONA-systems account OR
  - You were recruited via social media
- The purpose of the study is to see the effect mind wandering and text difficulty has on reading comprehension. The purpose of this is to try to see the level of cognitive difficulty that results in more mind wandering. Also, to see if interest level affects mind wandering and reading comprehension.

Description of the Study Procedures

- If you agree to be in this study, you will be asked to do the following things: Take a reading comprehension test on a computer or smartphone, which consists of eight passages for you to read and answer the corresponding questions at the end of each passage. As you read, you will be interrupted periodically with a question that asks if you were mind wandering while you read the previous sentence. After you finish reading all the passages and answering the corresponding reading comprehension questions, you will rate how interested you were in each passage that you previously read. The test should take you about 15 to 30 minutes.
- Some sample questions we will ask are: “The purpose of this passage is to” and “The best title for this selection would be” with responses in a multiple-choice format. The questions asked will be regarding the reading passages, such as the purpose of the passage, details about the text’s key events or characters and your overall interest in each passage. There will be no questions that could link your identity to your responses on the test.

Risks/Benefits/Compensation

- There are no anticipated significant risks, benefits, or compensation for completing this study.

Anonymity

- Your responses will be strictly anonymous; we will not be collecting or retaining any information about your identity. The findings will be presented at the 2020 Western Psychological Association Convention in San Francisco. The SPSS and Excel files of the participants' anonymous data will be archived indefinitely on the researchers' password protected laptops and will be uploaded onto the project's Open Science Framework (OSF) page. OSF is a website dedicated to promoting research and facilitating collaboration.

Right to Refuse or Withdraw

- The decision to participate in this study is entirely up to you. You may refuse to take part in the study at any time without affecting your relationship with the investigators of this study or Pacific Lutheran University. Your decision to refuse will not result in any loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. You have the right not to answer any single question, as well as to withdraw completely from the study at any point during the process. Because your participation is anonymous, it will not be possible to withdraw your survey answers from the study after you have submitted the survey.

Right to Ask Questions and Report Concerns

- You have the right to ask questions about this research and to have those questions answered by the researchers, before, during, or after the study. You may contact the primary investigators, Alexis Herion, at herionaw@plu.edu, and Cammy Widman, at widmancm@plu.edu, or the primary investigators' faculty advisor Heidi McLaughlin at mclaughlinh@plu.edu.
- If you have any other concerns about your rights as a research participant, you may contact the Human Participants Review Board, Pacific Lutheran University through the Provost's Office at (253) 535-7126.

Consent

- By clicking below to be taken to the survey, you indicate that you have read and understood the above, that you are at least 18 years of age, that you willingly agree to participate, and that you are not waiving any legal claims.
- If you would like to keep a copy of this document for your records, please save this page now.

◉ Take the Survey

→

-- Screen #2 --

The goal of this study is to learn how mind wandering affects how you learn information during reading. Mind wandering is a term used to describe what occurs when your attention wanders from a task. Sometimes when your mind wanders, you begin thinking about personal events or concerns rather than your task. At other times, your mind can wander because you are bored or tired and you don't really know what you're thinking about; all you know is that you are no longer thinking about your task.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #3 --

In this experiment, you will read 8 passages and answer reading comprehension questions for each passage. THE PASSAGES WILL BE PRESENTED IN A SENTENCE-BY-SENTENCE FASHION. PLEASE READ THE SENTENCES AT YOUR NORMAL READING PACE. ONCE YOU HAVE FINISHED READING ONE SENTENCE, PRESS THE ARROW TO MOVE ON TO THE NEXT SENTENCE. Once you've read the sentence you MAY NOT GO BACK.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #4 --

THE SET OF READING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS FOR THAT PARTICULAR PASSAGE YOU'VE FINISHED READING WILL APPEAR AFTER EACH PASSAGE, not all together at the end. Like the sentences, once you've answered the questions you MAY NOT GO BACK TO CHANGE YOUR ANSWER.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #5 --

After you complete the reading comprehension questions for each passage, you will be asked to rate your overall interest level in each passage. You MAY NOT GO BACK TO CHANGE YOUR ANSWER.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #6 --

Additionally, while you are reading you will be randomly interrupted and asked “WERE YOU MIND WANDERING WHEN YOU READ THE PREVIOUS SENTENCE?" as the question will appear on screen. That is, whether your thoughts were off-task rather than focusing on the prior sentence, in which you would have to choose either “Yes” or “No” in multiple choice format.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #7 --

This entire experiment is self-paced. Though of course you should try NOT TO go over the experiment's ending time of 30 minutes. So, try to do the task all the way through instead of taking too many small breaks in between. The experiment isn't long so you should be able to do it without taking any breaks.

Please press the arrow to *read the first passage.*

→

-- Screen #8 --

Passage 1

→

-- Screen #9 --

Elizabeth Barrett was wise enough to see that Browning was a fine poet.

→

-- Screen #10 --

The young man with the lemon-colored gloves and long dark hair and high-strung, restless manner who had visited her in 1846 had been moved to write to her because she had praised his poetry.

→

-- Screen #11 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #12 --

She found the man even more to her liking than the verse, and it was not so very long-only the time between May, 1845 and September, 1846-before Robert Browning had stolen the poetess from the dour father who guarded her like a dragon (never wanting her to marry any man), and taken her with him to Italy and a new life.

→

-- Screen #13 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #14 --

One morning, soon after Robert and Elizabeth married; she thrust a manuscript into Robert's pocket.

→

-- Screen #15 --

Then she ran up to her room, embarrassed by her action.

→

-- Screen #16 --

The manuscript was a sonnet sequence that she had written about their courtship and their love letters.

→

-- Screen #17 --

Mrs. Browning never intended for these poems to be published, but Robert promptly insisted that they must be.

→

-- Screen #18 --

He suggested calling them Sonnets from the Portuguese.

→

-- Screen #19 --

He may have suggested this title to hide the fact that the poems were personal.

→

-- Screen #20 --

He thought that these poems were “the finest sonnets written in our language since Shakespeare’s.”

→

-- Screen #21 --

Robert Browning’s opinion of Sonnets from the Portuguese was flattering to his wife, the same as his opinion of most of her poetry.

→

-- Screen #22 --

He thought that she was a better poet than he was, and the world at that time agreed with him.

→

-- Screen #23 --

He called her his “moon of poets,” and she considered him her sun.

→

-- Screen #24 --

Elizabeth Barrett Browning was a pure singer with a lovely lyrical tenderness.

→

-- Screen #25 --

She was the best poet of her sex since Sappho.

→

-- Screen #26 --

Her Sonnets reveal a woman’s secret soul like no other poetry in our literature up to that time.

→

-- Screen #27 --

They did so with autobiographical honesty, fine moderation and fullness.

→

-- Screen #28 --

Her lyrical mastery shines in many passages of her writings.

→

-- Screen #29 --

Italy was a kind of promised land for Elizabeth Browning.

→

-- Screen #30 --

In the summer, she and her husband lived in Florence or in little villages.

→

-- Screen #31 --

She drank in the sun of the south and the warmth of her husband’s love.

→

-- Screen #32 --

She blossomed in a life of delicate happiness for fifteen years.

→

-- Screen #33 --

She found friends in Italy, most of them cultured Americans.

→

-- Screen #34 --

Hawthorne saw the Browning's there: the New England thinker and essayist Margaret Fuller visited them.

→

-- Screen #35 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #36 --

The painter Story and the young sculptress Harriet Hosmer came.

→

-- Screen #37 --

One caller records that Robert Browning was “simple, natural, and playful,” and that Mrs. Browning was all “genius and sensibility.”

→

-- Screen #38 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #39 --

Daytimes Browning walked forth with Elizabeth's little dog Flush, but he seldom could be lured from his home evenings.

→

-- Screen #40 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #41 --

One privileged intruder, coming frequently at night to join the poets over hot chestnuts and mulled wine, found talk good and laughter plentiful.

→

-- Screen #42 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ( ) Yes
- (●) No

→

-- Screen #43 --

He found the talk good and the laughter plentiful.

→

-- Screen #44 --

The Brownings had a son, Robert Weidemann Browning, during the third year of their stay in Italy.

→

-- Screen #45 --

But a strain of dark dread began to creep through this happy life.

→

-- Screen #46 --

Elizabeth Browning’s father died still disapproving of her marriage.

→

-- Screen #47 --

He had refused to see her or to allow any of his family to see her.

→

-- Screen #48 --

Elizabeth’s dearly loved sister died and left three children who were all younger than her own boy.

→

-- Screen #49 --

Elizabeth drooped and grieved a little and Robert shielded her from ordinary visitors.

→

-- Screen #50 --

She had a sudden and alarming attack of sickness but was not considered in any danger.

→

-- Screen #51 --

One night, soon after, she awoke from a troubled sleep, apparently with no idea that she was about to leave Robert.

→

-- Screen #52 --

She spoke tenderly about her love for him. In his arms, her head drooped as though in a faint, but it was the end.

→

-- Screen #53 --

Profound and lasting was Browning's grief. “Looking back,” he said, “I see that we have been all the time walking over a torrent on a straw.”

→

-- Screen #54 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #55 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 1. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #56 --

Passage 1

1. Flush was the name of the Brownings'

- ( ) Cat
- ( ) Dog
- (●) Canary
- ( ) Turtle
- ( ) Thrush

→

-- Screen #57 --

2. At night the Brownings often enjoyed

- (●) hot chestnuts
- ( ) a tart with clotted cream
- ( ) strawberries and cream
- ( ) café au lait
- ( ) cheese soufflé

→

-- Screen #58 --

3. The Brownings saw

- ( ) Coleridge
- ( ) Byron
- ( ) Walt Whitman
- ( ) Poe
- (●) Hawthrone

→

-- Screen #59 --

4. Browning wrote to Miss Barrett because she had

- ( ) invited him to visit
- ( ) written him for advice
- ( ) praised his poetry
- ( ) sent him one of her own poems
- (●) sent a friend to meet him

→

-- Screen #60 --

5. The authors of this passage placed most attention on the Brownings'

- ○ literary efforts
- ◉ personal relationship
- ○ social contacts
- ○ problems
- ○ early meeting

→

-- Screen #61 --

6. What best describes the Brownings' early days abroad?

- ○ Travel
- ○ Relaxation
- ◉ Creative activity
- ○ Intellectual stimulation
- ○ Happiness

→

-- Screen #62 --

7. You would assume that Browning

- ○ found it easy to see Elizabeth
- ○ carefully avoided Mr. Barrett
- ○ begged Mr. Barrett's consent to marry
- ○ understood Mr. Barrett
- ◉ got Elizabeth to ask her father's consent

→

-- Screen #63 --

8. In the “torrent on a straw” quotation, the word straw probably refers to

- ○ the frailty of life
- ○ weakness of character
- ○ sorrow
- ◉ happiness
- ○ the fleeting nature of fame

→

-- Screen #64 --

Passage 2

→

-- Screen #65 --

The performance of those business activities that direct the flow of goods and services from producer to consumer or user is called marketing.

→

-- Screen #66 --

Marketing is the connecting link between the producer and the consumer or user.

→

-- Screen #67 --

Production and consumption are brought together by the marketing system.

→

-- Screen #68 --

Wholesaling or retailing activities are directly engaged in by approximately one in every six gainfully employed persons.

→

-- Screen #69 --

This ratio does not take into account other persons who are serving marketing through transportation, communication, and office vocations.

→

-- Screen #70 --

Opportunities for many kinds of positions requiring a wide range of skills and abilities is provided by marketing.

→

-- Screen #71 --

Although one naturally thinks of merchandising as being the primary occupation in marketing, there are opportunities in management, advertising, market and product research, and purchasing.

→

-- Screen #72 --

The economic well-being of one’s country is determined largely by productivity, consumption, and employment.

→

-- Screen #73 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #74 --

All three are affected by the efficiency of the marketing process.

→

-- Screen #75 --

If marketing stimulates appetite, people will consume goods at a high rate.

→

-- Screen #76 --

High consumption requires high productivity to meet the requirements of people, and high productivity and high-level activity in marketing combined result in high employment.

→

-- Screen #77 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #78 --

Indirectly, marketing is a key to a high level of economic living for the people.

→

-- Screen #79 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 2. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #80 --

Passage 2

1. Our economic well-being is determined largely by how many factors?

- ○ One
- ○ Two
- ◉ Three
- ○ Four
- ○ Five

→

-- Screen #81 --

2. One major factor mentioned as affecting our economic well-being was

- ○ high wages
- ○ low interest rates
- ○ technology
- ○ employment
- ◉ foreign trade

→

-- Screen #82 --

3. The purpose of this passage is to

- ○ persuade
- ○ guide
- ○ evaluate
- ◉ inform
- ○ interest

→

-- Screen #83 --

4. The chief emphasis is on

- ○ defining marketing
- ◉ principles of marketing
- ○ opportunities in marketing
- ○ kinds of jobs in marketing
- ○ the economic significance of marketing

→

-- Screen #84 --

Passage 3

→

-- Screen #85 --

The nucleus of an atom is held together by a kind of energy called atomic energy.

→

-- Screen #86 --

The sun’s energy comes from atomic reactions.

→

-- Screen #87 --

These reactions occur when the nuclei of hydrogen build up the nuclei of helium.

→

-- Screen #88 --

An atomic nucleus is made of particles, but the mass of the atomic nucleus is less than the total mass of the particles.

→

-- Screen #89 --

The reason for this is that part of the mass of particles is changed into energy when a nucleus is formed.

→

-- Screen #90 --

This energy then radiates away.

→

-- Screen #91 --

The quantity of energy released in reactions of this kind is almost inconceivably greater than the quantity released by any other type of reaction involving similar quantities of material.

→

-- Screen #92 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #93 --

Every second, the sun sends a million times more energy into space than we have stored in all of our coal, petroleum, and natural gas fields.

→

-- Screen #94 --

We could revolutionize the world if we could duplicate the method that releases such energy.

→

-- Screen #95 --

This possibility is not a fantasy, just as it was not a fantasy to imagine developing an atom bomb in 1900.

→

-- Screen #96 --

The time may come when the hydrogen from a cubic mile of sea water will provide enough energy to satisfy our needs at the 1960 rate for 300 centuries.

→

-- Screen #97 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #98 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 3. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #99 --

Passage 3

1. How much sea water was mentioned?

- ○ One ton
- ○ A cubic acre
- ○ A cubic mile
- ○ A thousand gallons
- ◉ A hundred tons

→

-- Screen #100 --

2. The quantity of energy released in an atomic reaction is spoken of as how much greater than with other types of reactions?

- ○ Far greater
- ○ Unbelievably greater
- ◉ A thousand times greater
- ○ Inconceivably greater
- ○ Tremendously greater

→

-- Screen #101 --

3. The primary focus is on

- ○ how energy is released
- ◉ where energy is found
- ○ the energy from atomic reactions
- ○ what happens in an atomic reactions
- ○ the energy present in sunshine

→

-- Screen #102 --

4. This passage is best described as

- ○ objective
- ◉ skeptical
- ○ cautious
- ○ conservative
- ○ optimistic

→

-- Screen #103 --

Passage 4

→

-- Screen #104 --

Even most skeptics, because they seem to share the hope that there is life on Mars, endeavor slavishly not to discount the possibility.

→

-- Screen #105 --

But it was a comedown in the mid-1960's when scientists involved in the Mars exploration studied photographs taken by some of the early Mariner space flights.

→

-- Screen #106 --

No canals.

→

-- Screen #107 --

No seas.

→

-- Screen #108 --

No busy Martian engineers.

→

-- Screen #109 --

No menacing warmongering Martians as colossal as skyscrapers.

→

-- Screen #110 --

Just mountains, craters, frigid winds, and dust storms.

→

-- Screen #111 --

It was almost as if scouts for Columbus had returned to Isabella's court with the news that the world had turned out to be flat after all.

→

-- Screen #112 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #113 --

Hopeful astronomers reminded us that the Mariner IV had photographed a mere one percent of the Martian surface from 2,000 miles away.

→

-- Screen #114 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #115 --

And they pointed out that the Earth-orbiting Tiros weather satellite shot over 20,000 pictures before uncovering any evidence of life on Earth.

→

-- Screen #116 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #117 --

But still, public enthusiasm for Martian exploration wilted.

→

-- Screen #118 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

→

-- Screen #119 --

By the time Viking I touched down on the Plain of Chryse in August, few seemed to care at all.

→

-- Screen #120 --

J. Richard Keefe, one of the Viking scientists, declared himself “disgusted” at what he called the “blasé…apathetic” public response and the skimpy television coverage of what was certainly one of the magnificent scientific and technical accomplishments in human history.

→

-- Screen #121 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 4. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #122 --

Passage 4

1. One weather satellite was named

- ○ Latos
- ◉ Tiros
- ○ Prometheus
- ○ Sonar
- ○ Satelos

→

-- Screen #123 --

2. One of the Mariners photographed how much of the surface or Mars?

- ○ One percent
- ◉ Two percent
- ○ Three percent
- ○ Four percent
- ○ Five percent

→

-- Screen #124 --

3. Interest in Mars diminished largely because

- ○ no Martians were found
- ○ the TV coverage was poor
- ○ the photos were all black and white
- ○ nothing was brought back to earth
- ◉ the media did not appreciate the accomplishment

→

-- Screen #125 --

4. Mention of the flat world was used to point out

- ◉ the flatness of Mars
- ○ the lack of canals
- ○ the lack of seas
- ○ the lack of Martians
- ○ the lack of mountains

→

-- Screen #126 --

Passage 5

→

-- Screen #127 --

Fungi give cheese the flavor, odor, and character that gourmets so highly prize.

→

-- Screen #128 --

One of the first molds was found in caves near the French village of Roquefort.

→

-- Screen #129 --

According to legend, a peasant boy left his lunch, which was a mild fresh piece of goat cheese, in one of the caves.

→

-- Screen #130 --

When he returned, he found the cheese marbled, tart, and fragrant.

→

-- Screen #131 --

Only cheeses that come from the area around these particular caves are allowed to bear the name of Roquefort.

→

-- Screen #132 --

As early as the seventeenth century, ergot, the fungus of rye, was used to facilitate childbirth.

→

-- Screen #133 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #134 --

It causes the contraction of involuntary muscles, particularly in the uterus.

→

-- Screen #135 --

In the twentieth century, ergot has once more attracted interest as the source of the chemical from which the hallucinogenic drug LSD is derived.

→

-- Screen #136 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

→

-- Screen #137 --

Most modern antibiotics are produced by fungi.

→

-- Screen #138 --

Alexander Fleming discovered the first of these antibiotics.

→

-- Screen #139 --

A mold of the genus Penicillium had contaminated a culture of staphylococcus bacteria that was growing on a nutrient agar plate.

→

-- Screen #140 --

Alexander noted that the mold completely halted the growth of the bacteria.

→

-- Screen #141 --

Antibiotics, of which many hundreds have now been discovered, are substances produced by a living organism that injure another living organism.

→

-- Screen #142 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #143 --

All of these are substances produced by one living organism that injures another living organism.

→

-- Screen #144 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 5. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #145 --

1. A fungus was used as medicine as early as what century?

- ○ Sixteenth
- ○ Seventeenth
- ○ Eighteenth
- ○ Nineteenth
- ◉ Twentieth

→

-- Screen #146 --

2. How many antibiotics have been discovered?

- ○ Ninety-six
- ○ Many hundreds
- ○ Thousands
- ◉ Millions
- ○ An unspecified number

→

-- Screen #147 --

3. This passage is mainly about

- ergot
- drugs
- fungi
- antibiotics
- cheese

→

-- Screen #148 --

4. LSD is specifically mentioned to show that ergot

- needs to be further controlled
- needs further research
- has medicinal value
- is of current interest
- is dangerous

→

-- Screen #149 --

Passage 6

→

-- Screen #150 --

Local governments were our first governments.

→

-- Screen #151 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #152 --

The primitive tribe that chose the strongest man to be its chief and the oldest men to form a council was establishing local government.

→

-- Screen #153 --

It was seeking a better, safer life.

→

-- Screen #154 --

In the same way, the need for rules and leaders was realized by the first English settlers who landed at Jamestown, Virginia, in 1607.

→

-- Screen #155 --

At first, the settlers at Jamestown had to shepherd themselves.

→

-- Screen #156 --

The colonists searched for gold, and had to find their own sustenance and provide their own sanctuary.

→

-- Screen #157 --

As food supplies began to run low, and as the colonists faced hunger and disease, they saw that they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

→

-- Screen #158 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #159 --

A council to make laws for the colony was formed by the settlers.

→

-- Screen #160 --

Captain John Smith was chosen as president of the council to see that the laws were implemented.

→

-- Screen #161 --

This government at Jamestown was the first local government in America.

→

-- Screen #162 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #163 --

Today, local government is still the first and most important government in our lives.

→

-- Screen #164 --

It protects our lives, our safety, and our homes, and it helps to keep our environment clean.

→

-- Screen #165 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #166 --

Schools, libraries, and other important services are provided to us by local government.

→

-- Screen #167 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 6. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #168 --

Passage 6

1. The first colonial government was

- ○ tribal
- ○ city
- ◉ county
- ○ local
- ○ federal

→

-- Screen #169 --

2. The Jamestown colonists formed a government because of

- ○ pride
- ◉ greed
- ○ necessity
- ○ togetherness
- ○ public spirit

→

-- Screen #170 --

3. The best title for this selection would be

- ○ John Smith
- ○ The First Government
- ○ Jamestown
- ○ Local Government
- ◉ American Government

→

-- Screen #171 --

4. The overall goal of local government seems to be public

- ○ regulation
- ○ wealth
- ○ growth
- ○ welfare
- ◉ protection

→

-- Screen #172 --

Passage 7

→

-- Screen #173 --

Once in a while you will hear about an artist who was recognized as a master during his lifetime, but was then almost forgotten after his death.

→

-- Screen #174 --

A good example is the painter, Domenicos Theotocopoulos.

→

-- Screen #175 --

He was known as El Greco because of his Greek ancestry.

→

-- Screen #176 --

After pursuing his early career in Italy, El Greco settled in the Spanish city of Toledo, where he prospered for the rest of his life.

→

-- Screen #177 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

→

-- Screen #178 --

He prospered there for the rest of his life.

→

-- Screen #179 --

History forgot El Greco for nearly three hundred years.

→

-- Screen #180 --

Then, artists and critics of the twentieth century rediscovered him.

→

-- Screen #181 --

The power of El Greco's intensely emotional style can be felt most strongly in his later paintings, such as the famous View of Toledo.

→

-- Screen #182 --

He painted this canvas in 1610, only a few years before his death.

→

-- Screen #183 --

It is a strange landscape.

→

-- Screen #184 --

One notices that eerie, silvery buildings take on a ghostlike stillness next to the explosive light of the sky and the writhing forms of the countryside below.

→

-- Screen #185 --

Curiously, about the same time, another important artist was scorned even by many of his contemporaries.

→

-- Screen #186 --

This artist was Caravaggio.

→

-- Screen #187 --

He was a self-taught painter who came to Rome around 1590 from a small town in Lombardy.

→

-- Screen #188 --

Caravaggio's critics complained that he treated sacred religious subjects in a low, vulgar way by including the faces and figures of common people in his paintings.

→

-- Screen #189 --

By using stark contrasts of light and shadow, Caravaggio managed to conjure up unforgettable scenes of dramatic realism.

→

-- Screen #190 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #191 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 7. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #192 --

Passage 7

1. In his paintings, Caravaggio included

- ○ common people
- ○ strange landscapes
- ○ eerie, silvery buildings
- ◉ ghosts
- ○ corpses

→

-- Screen #193 --

2. El Greco pursued his early career in

- ◉ Italy
- ○ Greece
- ○ Lombardy
- ○ Rome
- ○ Toledo

→

-- Screen #194 --

3. Apparently a major technique of Caravaggio's was

- (●) using exalted religious subjects
- ( ) using stark contrasts
- ( ) using cadavers
- ( ) using ghostlike stillness
- ( ) none of the above

→

-- Screen #195 --

4. the principal idea discussed in this passage concerns

- ( ) El Greco
- ( ) Caravaggio
- ( ) Contemporary approval of artists
- ( ) The travels of painters
- (●) The prosperity of artists

→

-- Screen #196 --

Passage 8

→

-- Screen #197 --

The key to the design called experimental is assignment of subjects to conditions randomly.

→

-- Screen #198 --

By the influence on the results of some extraneous variable that is tied to or correlated with the variable under investigation is insured against.

→

-- Screen #199 --

By contrast with experimental designs, subjects, in correlational designs, in a sense, assign themselves to conditions.

→

-- Screen #200 --

Thus, in the cancer studies as they have been done, only people who are four-pack-a-day smokers—by their own “choice”—get into a four-pack-a-day condition.

→

-- Screen #201 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #202 --

Whatever the factors are that contribute to a person’s being a heavy smoker surely must also make him different from the typical nonsmoker in other ways.

→

-- Screen #203 --

Hence the ambiguity of interpretation in correlational designs, and hence the virtue of experimental designs.

→

-- Screen #204 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

→

-- Screen #205 --

In the latter case, if assignment to conditions is truly random then prevailing differences among individual subjects cannot confound the results systematically.

→

-- Screen #206 --

Put another way, the experimenter has under his control all the variables that can influence the results.

→

-- Screen #207 --

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ( ) Yes
- (●) No

→

-- Screen #208 --

Whether he can exactly identify these variables is another question.

→

-- Screen #209 --

Thus, entirely unambiguous results are not yielded by experimental designs, merely results that are less ambiguous than those associated with correlational designs.

→

-- Screen #210 --

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 8. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

-- Screen #211 --

1. Specific mention is made of

- ○ psychogenesis
- ○ psychodynamics
- ○ psychobiology
- ◉ psychotherapy
- ○ none of the above

→

-- Screen #212 --

2. How many research design patterns were discussed?

- ○ One only
- ○ Two
- ○ Three
- ◉ Four
- ○ Five

→

-- Screen #213 --

3. As used in this passage, the phrase "put another way" means

- ◉ rephrasing
- ○ enumeration
- ○ using details
- ○ reasoning
- ○ illustration

→

-- Screen #214 --

4. In this passage the authors imply that heavy smoking is probably caused by

- ○ tension
- ○ nervousness
- ◉ habit
- ○ social pressure
- ○ all the above and more

→

-- Screen #215 --

You have finished the reading comprehension test.

Now, please rate your interest level for each of the eight passages that you just read.

	Extremely Uninterested	Moderately Uninterested	Somewhat Uninterested	Neutral or Undecided	Somewhat Interested	Moderately Interested	Extremely Interested
Passage 1. *The Browning Poets*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 2. *Marketing*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 3. *Atomic Energy and the Atomic Bomb*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 4. *Mars and Space*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 5. *Fungi and Antibiotics*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 6. *Jamestown and Government*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 7. *The Artists El Greco and Caravaggio*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 8. *Experimental and Correlational Designs*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

→

-- Screen #216 --

End of Experiment

The purpose of this experiment is to assess the effect of mind-wandering on reading difficulty. Some of the passages are difficult to comprehend and some are easy to comprehend. The hypothesis for this experiment is that you will mind-wander more while reading the hard passages relative to the easy passages. Your performance on the reading comprehension test will also go down as you mind-wander. Additionally, you should read relatively slower during the hard condition than the easy condition.

Thank You for Participating!

Debriefing
Pacific Lutheran University

Title of Study: The effect of mind wandering and text difficulty on reading comprehension: A replication study.

Investigator(s):
Alexis Herion, Psychology Department, herionaw@plu.edu
Cammy Widman, Psychology Department, widmancm@plu.edu

Faculty Supervisor:
Heidi McLaughlin, Psychology Department, mclaughlinh@plu.edu

……

Thank you for your participation in our research study. The purpose of the study is to test the effect of mind wandering and text difficulty on reading comprehension.

We were interested in the topic because past research has shown that mind wandering has influenced areas such as reading comprehension. We expanded on that by doing a replication study that measured mind wandering and reading comprehension while manipulating the variable of text difficulty. We wanted to know if the results of the previous study would be consistent at PLU. We also added the variable of interest in the reading passages to test whether or not interest affects the amount of mind wandering.

We hypothesized that mind wandering would increase while reading the difficult texts, thus causing a decrease in reading comprehension.

The findings of this study will be presented at the 2020 Western Psychological Association Convention in San Francisco.

If you have any questions or concerns please feel free to contact one of us, or our faculty supervisor at the email listed at the top.

If you have any questions or concerns about this study or your rights as a study participant, you may contact the Human Participants Review Board, Pacific Lutheran University through the Provost's Office at (253) 535-7126.

Please do not discuss this study with other potential participants until the semester is over. If people know what we are testing before the study begins, they may respond differently, jeopardizing our results.

Thank you again for your help!

→

-- Screen #217 --

We thank you for your time spent taking this survey. Your response has been recorded.

Part 2: full survey design

Part 2: the full survey with all variations, including validation, randomization rules, js code, etc.

Text styles used below

Green text	*Rules participants do not see: display logic, branches, randomization, validation, timers.*
`text1`	`Text dynamically generated during the survey by randomization or past responses.`
red [1A] blue [1B]	Text that differs by randomly assigned condition. | The small label names the condition ([1A], [1B]).

Back button: not shown.

28 blocks · 727 questions · 1 randomizer

Block 1 Consent Form

-- Screen #218 --

Q1

Consent to Participate in a Research Study
Pacific Lutheran University

Title of Study: The effect of mind wandering and text difficulty on reading comprehension: A replication study.
Investigators: Alexis Herion and Cammy Widman, senior undergraduate students
Introduction

- You are being asked to be in a research study conducted at Pacific Lutheran University in Psychology.
- You were selected to participate because you are at least 18 years old AND:
  - You are a PLU student with a SONA-systems account OR
  - You were recruited via social media
- The purpose of the study is to see the effect mind wandering and text difficulty has on reading comprehension. The purpose of this is to try to see the level of cognitive difficulty that results in more mind wandering. Also, to see if interest level affects mind wandering and reading comprehension.

Description of the Study Procedures

- If you agree to be in this study, you will be asked to do the following things: Take a reading comprehension test on a computer or smartphone, which consists of eight passages for you to read and answer the corresponding questions at the end of each passage. As you read, you will be interrupted periodically with a question that asks if you were mind wandering while you read the previous sentence. After you finish reading all the passages and

answering the corresponding reading comprehension questions, you will rate how interested you were in each passage that you previously read. The test should take you about 15 to 30 minutes.
- Some sample questions we will ask are: “The purpose of this passage is to” and “The best title for this selection would be” with responses in a multiple-choice format. The questions asked will be regarding the reading passages, such as the purpose of the passage, details about the text’s key events or characters and your overall interest in each passage. There will be no questions that could link your identity to your responses on the test.

Risks/Benefits/Compensation

- There are no anticipated significant risks, benefits, or compensation for completing this study.

Anonymity

- Your responses will be strictly anonymous; we will not be collecting or retaining any information about your identity. The findings will be presented at the 2020 Western Psychological Association Convention in San Francisco. The SPSS and Excel files of the participants’ anonymous data will be archived indefinitely on the researchers’ password protected laptops and will be uploaded onto the project’s Open Science Framework (OSF) page. OSF is a website dedicated to promoting research and facilitating collaboration.

Right to Refuse or Withdraw

- The decision to participate in this study is entirely up to you. You may refuse to take part in the study at any time without affecting your relationship with the investigators of this study or Pacific Lutheran University. Your decision to refuse will not result in any loss of benefits to which you are otherwise entitled. You have the right not to answer any single question, as well as to withdraw completely from the study at any point during the process. Because your participation is anonymous, it will not be possible to withdraw your survey answers from the study after you have submitted the survey.

Right to Ask Questions and Report Concerns

- You have the right to ask questions about this research and to have those questions answered by the researchers, before, during, or after the study. You may contact the primary investigators, Alexis Herion, at herionaw@plu.edu, and Cammy Widman, at widmancm@plu.edu, or the primary investigators’ faculty advisor Heidi McLaughlin at mclaughlinh@plu.edu.
- If you have any other concerns about your rights as a research participant, you may contact the Human Participants Review Board, Pacific Lutheran University through the Provost’s Office at (253) 535-7126.

Consent

- By clicking below to be taken to the survey, you indicate that you have read and understood

the above, that you are at least 18 years of age, that you willingly agree to participate, and that you are not waiving any legal claims.

- If you would like to keep a copy of this document for your records, please save this page now.

◯ Take the Survey

Response required.

→

Block 2 Directions

-- Screen #219 --

Q2

The goal of this study is to learn how mind wandering affects how you learn information during reading. Mind wandering is a term used to describe what occurs when your attention wanders from a task. Sometimes when your mind wanders, you begin thinking about personal events or concerns rather than your task. At other times, your mind can wander because you are bored or tired and you don't really know what you're thinking about; all you know is that you are no longer thinking about your task.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #220 --

Q3

In this experiment, you will read 8 passages and answer reading comprehension questions for each passage. THE PASSAGES WILL BE PRESENTED IN A SENTENCE-BY-SENTENCE FASHION. PLEASE READ THE SENTENCES AT YOUR NORMAL READING PACE. ONCE YOU HAVE FINISHED READING ONE SENTENCE, PRESS THE ARROW TO MOVE ON TO THE NEXT SENTENCE. Once you've read the sentence you MAY NOT GO BACK.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #221 --

Q4

THE SET OF READING COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS FOR THAT PARTICULAR PASSAGE YOU'VE FINISHED READING WILL APPEAR AFTER EACH PASSAGE, not all together at the end. Like the sentences, once you've answered the questions you MAY NOT GO BACK TO CHANGE YOUR ANSWER.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #222 --

Q5

After you complete the reading comprehension questions for each passage, you will be asked to rate your overall interest level in each passage. You MAY NOT GO BACK TO CHANGE YOUR ANSWER.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #223 --

Q6

Additionally, while you are reading you will be randomly interrupted and asked "WERE YOU MIND WANDERING WHEN YOU READ THE PREVIOUS SENTENCE?" as the question will appear on screen. That is, whether your thoughts were off-task rather than focusing on the prior sentence, in which you would have to choose either "Yes" or "No" in multiple choice format.

Please press the arrow to continue.

→

-- Screen #224 --

Q7

This entire experiment is self-paced. Though of course you should try NOT TO go over the experiment's ending time of 30 minutes. So, try to do the task all the way through instead of taking too many small breaks in between. The experiment isn't long so you should be able to do it without taking any breaks.

Please press the arrow to *read the first passage.*

→

▸ Random assignment #1: each participant sees one of the following 2 conditions (evenly presented).

1A Booklet 2: Block “Passage 1 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 1 Questions” + Block “Passage 2 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 2 Questions” + Block “Passage 3 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 3 Questions” + Block “Passage 4 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 4 Questions” + Block “Passage 5 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 5 Questions” + Block “Passage 6 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 6 Questions” + Block “Passage 7 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 7 Questions” + Block “Passage 8 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 8 Questions”

1B Booklet 1: Block “Passage 1 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 1 Questions” + Block “Passage 2 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 2 Questions” + Block “Passage 3 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 3 Questions” + Block “Passage 4 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 4 Questions” + Block “Passage 5 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 5 Questions” + Block “Passage 6 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 6 Questions” + Block “Passage 7 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 7 Questions” + Block “Passage 8 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 8 Questions”

1A Booklet 2: Block “Passage 1 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 1 Questions” + Block “Passage 2 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 2 Questions” + Block “Passage 3 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 3 Questions” + Block “Passage 4 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 4 Questions” + Block “Passage 5 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 5 Questions” + Block “Passage 6 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 6 Questions” + Block “Passage 7 Easy Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 7 Questions” + Block “Passage 8 Difficult Booklet 2” + Block “Passage 8 Questions”

Block 3 Passage 1 Easy Booklet 2

-- Screen #225 --

Q8

Passage 1

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q377) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #226 --

Q9

Elizabeth Barrett was wise enough to see that Browning was a fine poet.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q376) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #227 --

Q10

The young man with the lemon-colored gloves and long dark hair and high-strung, restless manner who had visited her in 1846 had been moved to write to her because she had praised his poetry.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q378) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #228 --

Q11

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q379) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #229 --

Q12

She found the man even more to her liking than the verse, and it was not so very long-only the time between May, 1845 and September, 1846-before Robert Browning had stolen the poetess from the dour father who guarded her like a dragon (never wanting her to marry any man), and taken her with him to Italy and a new life.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q380) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #230 --

Q13

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q381) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #231 --

Q14

One morning, soon after Robert and Elizabeth married; she thrust a manuscript into Robert's pocket.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q382) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #232 --

Q15

Then she ran up to her room, embarrassed by her action.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q383) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #233 --

Q16

The manuscript was a sonnet sequence that she had written about their courtship and their love letters.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q384) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #234 --

Q17

Mrs. Browning never intended for these poems to be published, but Robert promptly insisted that they must be.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q385) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #235 --

Q18

He suggested calling them Sonnets from the Portuguese.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q386) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #236 --

Q19

He may have suggested this title to hide the fact that the poems were personal.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q387) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #237 --

Q20

He thought that these poems were “the finest sonnets written in our language since Shakespeare’s.”

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q388) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #238 --

Q21

Robert Browning's opinion of Sonnets from the Portuguese was flattering to his wife, the same as his opinion of most of her poetry.

Hidden page timer (Q389) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #239 --

Q22

He thought that she was a better poet than he was, and the world at that time agreed with him.

Hidden page timer (Q390) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #240 --

Q23

He called her his "moon of poets," and she considered him her sun.

Hidden page timer (Q391) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #241 --

Q24

Elizabeth Barrett Browning was a pure singer with a lovely lyrical tenderness.

Hidden page timer (Q392) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #242 --

Q25

She was the best poet of her sex since Sappho.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q393) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #243 --

Q26

Her Sonnets reveal a woman's secret soul like no other poetry in our literature up to that time.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q394) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #244 --

Q27

They did so with autobiographical honesty, fine moderation and fullness.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q395) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #245 --

Q28

Her lyrical mastery shines in many passages of her writings.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q396) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #246 --

Q29

Italy was a kind of promised land for Elizabeth Browning.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q397) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #247 --

Q30

In the summer, she and her husband lived in Florence or in little villages.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q398) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #248 --

Q31

She drank in the sun of the south and the warmth of her husband’s love.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q399) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #249 --

Q32

She blossomed in a life of delicate happiness for fifteen years.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q400) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #250 --

Q33

She found friends in Italy, most of them cultured Americans.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q401) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #251 --

Q34

Hawthorne saw the Browning's there: the New England thinker and essayist Margaret Fuller visited them.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q402) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #252 --

Q35

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q403) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #253 --

Q36

The painter Story and the young sculptress Harriet Hosmer came.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q404) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #254 --

Q37

One caller records that Robert Browning was “simple, natural, and playful,” and that Mrs. Browning was all “genius and sensibility.”

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q405) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #255 --

Q38

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q406) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #256 --

Q39

Daytimes Browning walked forth with Elizabeth's little dog Flush, but he seldom could be lured from his home evenings.

Hidden page timer (Q407) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #257 --

Q40

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q408) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #258 --

Q41

One privileged intruder, coming frequently at night to join the poets over hot chestnuts and mulled wine, found talk good and laughter plentiful.

Hidden page timer (Q409) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #259 --

Q42

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q410) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #260 --

Q43

He found the talk good and the laughter plentiful.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q411) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #261 --

Q44

The Brownings had a son, Robert Weidemann Browning, during the third year of their stay in Italy.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q412) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #262 --

Q45

But a strain of dark dread began to creep through this happy life.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q413) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #263 --

Q46

Elizabeth Browning's father died still disapproving of her marriage.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q414) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #264 --

Q47

He had refused to see her or to allow any of his family to see her.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q415) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #265 --

Q48

Elizabeth’s dearly loved sister died and left three children who were all younger than her own boy.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q416) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #266 --

Q49

Elizabeth drooped and grieved a little and Robert shielded her from ordinary visitors.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q417) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #267 --

Q50

She had a sudden and alarming attack of sickness but was not considered in any danger.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q418) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #268 --

Q51

One night, soon after, she awoke from a troubled sleep, apparently with no idea that she was about to leave Robert.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q419) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #269 --

Q52

She spoke tenderly about her love for him. In his arms, her head drooped as though in a faint, but it was the end.

Hidden page timer (Q420) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #270 --

Q53

Profound and lasting was Browning's grief. “Looking back,” he said, “I see that we have been all the time walking over a torrent on a straw.”

Hidden page timer (Q421) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #271 --

Q54

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q422) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #272 --

Q55

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 1. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

Hidden page timer (Q423) records time spent on this page.

→

Block 4 Passage 1 Questions

-- Screen #273 --

Q56

Passage 1

1. Flush was the name of the Brownings'

- ◯ Cat
- ◯ Dog
- ◯ Canary
- ◯ Turtle
- ◯ Thrush

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q425) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #274 --

Q57

2. At night the Brownings often enjoyed

- ◯ hot chestnuts
- ◯ a tart with clotted cream
- ◯ strawberries and cream
- ◯ café au lait
- ◯ cheese soufflé

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q426) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #275 --

Q58

3. The Brownings saw

- ◯ Coleridge
- ◯ Byron
- ◯ Walt Whitman
- ◯ Poe
- ◯ Hawthrone

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q427) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #276 --

Q59

4. Browning wrote to Miss Barrett because she had

- ◯ invited him to visit
- ◯ written him for advice
- ◯ praised his poetry
- ◯ sent him one of her own poems
- ◯ sent a friend to meet him

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q428) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #277 --

Q60

5. The authors of this passage placed most attention on the Brownings'

- ◯ literary efforts
- ◯ personal relationship
- ◯ social contacts
- ◯ problems
- ◯ early meeting

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q429) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #278 --

Q61

6. What best describes the Brownings' early days abroad?

- ◯ Travel
- ◯ Relaxation
- ◯ Creative activity
- ◯ Intellectual stimulation
- ◯ Happiness

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q430) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #279 --

Q62

7. You would assume that Browning

- ◯ found it easy to see Elizabeth
- ◯ carefully avoided Mr. Barrett
- ◯ begged Mr. Barrett's consent to marry
- ◯ understood Mr. Barrett
- ◯ got Elizabeth to ask her father's consent

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q431) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #280 --

Q63

8. In the "torrent on a straw" quotation, the word straw probably refers to

- ◯ the frailty of life
- ◯ weakness of character
- ◯ sorrow
- ◯ happiness
- ◯ the fleeting nature of fame

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q432) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 5 Passage 2 Difficult Booklet 2

-- Screen #281 --

Q64

Passage 2

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q433) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #282 --

Q65

The performance of those business activities that direct the flow of goods and services from producer to consumer or user is called marketing.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q434) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #283 --

Q66

Marketing is the connecting link between the producer and the consumer or user.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q435) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #284 --

Q67

Production and consumption are brought together by the marketing system.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q436) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #285 --

Q68

Wholesaling or retailing activities are directly engaged in by approximately one in every six gainfully employed persons.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q437) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #286 --

Q69

This ratio does not take into account other persons who are serving marketing through transportation, communication, and office vocations.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q438) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #287 --

Q70

Opportunities for many kinds of positions requiring a wide range of skills and abilities is provided by marketing.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q439) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #288 --

Q71

Although one naturally thinks of merchandising as being the primary occupation in marketing, there are opportunities in management, advertising, market and product research, and purchasing.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q440) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #289 --

Q72

The economic well-being of one's country is determined largely by productivity, consumption, and employment.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q441) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #290 --

Q73

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q442) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #291 --

Q74

All three are affected by the efficiency of the marketing process.

Hidden page timer (Q443) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #292 --

Q75

If marketing stimulates appetite, people will consume goods at a high rate.

Hidden page timer (Q444) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #293 --

Q76

High consumption requires high productivity to meet the requirements of people, and high productivity and high-level activity in marketing combined result in high employment.

Hidden page timer (Q445) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #294 --

Q77

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q446) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #295 --

Q78

Indirectly, marketing is a key to a high level of economic living for the people.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q447) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #296 --

Q79

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 2. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q448) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 6 Passage 2 Questions

-- Screen #297 --

Q81

Passage 2

1. Our economic well-being is determined largely by how many factors?

- ◯ One
- ◯ Two
- ◯ Three
- ◯ Four
- ◯ Five

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q449) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #298 --

Q82

2. One major factor mentioned as affecting our economic well-being was

- ◯ high wages
- ◯ low interest rates
- ◯ technology
- ◯ employment
- ◯ foreign trade

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q450) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #299 --

Q83

3. The purpose of this passage is to

- ◯ persuade
- ◯ guide
- ◯ evaluate
- ◯ inform
- ◯ interest

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q451) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #300 --

Q84

4. The chief emphasis is on

- ◯ defining marketing
- ◯ principles of marketing
- ◯ opportunities in marketing
- ◯ kinds of jobs in marketing
- ◯ the economic significance of marketing

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q452) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 7 Passage 3 Easy Booklet 2

-- Screen #301 --

Q86

Passage 3

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q453) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #302 --

Q87

The nucleus of an atom is held together by a kind of energy called atomic energy.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q454) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #303 --

Q88

The sun’s energy comes from atomic reactions.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q455) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #304 --

Q89

These reactions occur when the nuclei of hydrogen build up the nuclei of helium.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q456) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #305 --

Q90

An atomic nucleus is made of particles, but the mass of the atomic nucleus is less than the total mass of the particles.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q457) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #306 --

Q91

The reason for this is that part of the mass of particles is changed into energy when a nucleus is formed.

Hidden page timer (Q458) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #307 --

Q92

This energy then radiates away.

Hidden page timer (Q459) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #308 --

Q93

The quantity of energy released in reactions of this kind is almost inconceivably greater than the quantity released by any other type of reaction involving similar quantities of material.

Hidden page timer (Q460) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #309 --

Q94

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q461) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #310 --

Q95

Every second, the sun sends a million times more energy into space than we have stored in all of our coal, petroleum, and natural gas fields.

Hidden page timer (Q462) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #311 --

Q96

We could revolutionize the world if we could duplicate the method that releases such energy.

Hidden page timer (Q463) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #312 --

Q97

This possibility is not a fantasy, just as it was not a fantasy to imagine developing an atom bomb in 1900.

Hidden page timer (Q464) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #313 --

Q98

The time may come when the hydrogen from a cubic mile of sea water will provide enough energy to satisfy our needs at the 1960 rate for 300 centuries.

Hidden page timer (Q465) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #314 --

Q99

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q466) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #315 --

Q100

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 3. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q467) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 8 Passage 3 Questions

-- Screen #316 --

Q101

Passage 3

1. How much sea water was mentioned?

- ◯ One ton
- ◯ A cubic acre
- ◯ A cubic mile
- ◯ A thousand gallons
- ◯ A hundred tons

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q468) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #317 --

Q102

2. The quantity of energy released in an atomic reaction is spoken of as how much greater than with other types of reactions?

- ◯ Far greater
- ◯ Unbelievably greater
- ◯ A thousand times greater
- ◯ Inconceivably greater
- ◯ Tremendously greater

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q469) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #318 --

Q103

3. The primary focus is on

- ◯ how energy is released
- ◯ where energy is found
- ◯ the energy from atomic reactions
- ◯ what happens in an atomic reactions
- ◯ the energy present in sunshine

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q470) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #319 --

Q104

4. This passage is best described as

- ◯ objective
- ◯ skeptical
- ◯ cautious
- ◯ conservative
- ◯ optimistic

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q471) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 9 Passage 4 Difficult Booklet 2

-- Screen #320 --

Q106

Passage 4

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q472) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #321 --

Q107

Even most skeptics, because they seem to share the hope that there is life on Mars, endeavor slavishly not to discount the possibility.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q473) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #322 --

Q108

But it was a comedown in the mid-1960's when scientists involved in the Mars exploration studied photographs taken by some of the early Mariner space flights.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q474) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #323 --

Q109

No canals.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q475) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #324 --

Q110

No seas.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q476) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #325 --

Q111

No busy Martian engineers.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q477) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #326 --

Q112

No menacing warmongering Martians as colossal as skyscrapers.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q478) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #327 --

Q113

Just mountains, craters, frigid winds, and dust storms.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q479) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #328 --

Q114

It was almost as if scouts for Columbus had returned to Isabella's court with the news that the world had turned out to be flat after all.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q480) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #329 --

Q115

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q481) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #330 --

Q116

Hopeful astronomers reminded us that the Mariner IV had photographed a mere one percent of the Martian surface from 2,000 miles away.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q482) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #331 --

Q117

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q483) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #332 --

Q118

And they pointed out that the Earth-orbiting Tiros weather satellite shot over 20,000 pictures before uncovering any evidence of life on Earth.

Hidden page timer (Q484) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #333 --

Q119

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q485) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #334 --

Q120

But still, public enthusiasm for Martian exploration wilted.

Hidden page timer (Q486) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #335 --

Q121

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q487) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #336 --

Q122

By the time Viking I touched down on the Plain of Chryse in August, few seemed to care at all.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q488) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #337 --

Q123

J. Richard Keefe, one of the Viking scientists, declared himself “disgusted” at what he called the “blasé…apathetic” public response and the skimpy television coverage of what was certainly one of the magnificent scientific and technical accomplishments in human history.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q489) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #338 --

Q124

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 4. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q490) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 10 Passage 4 Questions

-- Screen #339 --

Q125

Passage 4

1. One weather satellite was named

- ◯ Latos
- ◯ Tiros
- ◯ Prometheus
- ◯ Sonar
- ◯ Satelos

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q491) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #340 --

Q126

2. One of the Mariners photographed how much of the surface or Mars?

- ◯ One percent
- ◯ Two percent
- ◯ Three percent
- ◯ Four percent
- ◯ Five percent

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q492) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #341 --

Q127

3. Interest in Mars diminished largely because

- ◯ no Martians were found
- ◯ the TV coverage was poor
- ◯ the photos were all black and white
- ◯ nothing was brought back to earth
- ◯ the media did not appreciate the accomplishment

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q493) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #342 --

Q128

4. Mention of the flat world was used to point out

- ◯ the flatness of Mars
- ◯ the lack of canals
- ◯ the lack of seas
- ◯ the lack of Martians
- ◯ the lack of mountains

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q494) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 11 Passage 5 Easy Booklet 2

-- Screen #343 --

Q130

Passage 5

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q495) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #344 --

Q131

Fungi give cheese the flavor, odor, and character that gourmets so highly prize.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q496) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #345 --

Q132

One of the first molds was found in caves near the French village of Roquefort.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q497) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #346 --

Q133

According to legend, a peasant boy left his lunch, which was a mild fresh piece of goat cheese, in one of the caves.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q498) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #347 --

Q134

When he returned, he found the cheese marbled, tart, and fragrant.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q499) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #348 --

Q135

Only cheeses that come from the area around these particular caves are allowed to bear the name of Roquefort.

Hidden page timer (Q500) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #349 --

Q136

As early as the seventeenth century, ergot, the fungus of rye, was used to facilitate childbirth.

Hidden page timer (Q501) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #350 --

Q137

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q502) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #351 --

Q138

It causes the contraction of involuntary muscles, particularly in the uterus.

Hidden page timer (Q503) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #352 --

Q139

In the twentieth century, ergot has once more attracted interest as the source of the chemical from which the hallucinogenic drug LSD is derived.

Hidden page timer (Q504) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #353 --

Q140

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q505) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #354 --

Q141

Most modern antibiotics are produced by fungi.

Hidden page timer (Q506) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #355 --

Q142

Alexander Fleming discovered the first of these antibiotics.

Hidden page timer (Q507) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #356 --

Q143

A mold of the genus Penicillium had contaminated a culture of staphylococcus bacteria that was growing on a nutrient agar plate.

Hidden page timer (Q508) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #357 --

Q144

Alexander noted that the mold completely halted the growth of the bacteria.

Hidden page timer (Q509) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #358 --

Q145

Antibiotics, of which many hundreds have now been discovered, are substances produced by a living organism that injure another living organism.

Hidden page timer (Q510) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #359 --

Q146

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q511) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #360 --

Q147

All of these are substances produced by one living organism that injures another living organism.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q512) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #361 --

Q148

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 5. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q513) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 12 Passage 5 Questions

-- Screen #362 --

Q149

1. A fungus was used as medicine as early as what century?

- ◯ Sixteenth
- ◯ Seventeenth
- ◯ Eighteenth
- ◯ Nineteenth
- ◯ Twentieth

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q514) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #363 --

Q150

2. How many antibiotics have been discovered?

- ◯ Ninety-six
- ◯ Many hundreds
- ◯ Thousands
- ◯ Millions
- ◯ An unspecified number

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q515) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #364 --

Q151

3. This passage is mainly about

- ◯ ergot
- ◯ drugs
- ◯ fungi
- ◯ antibiotics
- ◯ cheese

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q516) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #365 --

Q152

4. LSD is specifically mentioned to show that ergot

- ◯ needs to be further controlled
- ◯ needs further research
- ◯ has medicinal value
- ◯ is of current interest
- ◯ is dangerous

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q517) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 13 Passage 6 Difficult Booklet 2

-- Screen #366 --

Q154

Passage 6

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q518) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #367 --

Q155

Local governments were our first governments.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q519) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #368 --

Q156

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q520) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #369 --

Q157

The primitive tribe that chose the strongest man to be its chief and the oldest men to form a council was establishing local government.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q521) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #370 --

Q158

It was seeking a better, safer life.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q522) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #371 --

Q159

In the same way, the need for rules and leaders was realized by the first English settlers who landed at Jamestown, Virginia, in 1607.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q523) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #372 --

Q160

At first, the settlers at Jamestown had to shepherd themselves.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q524) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #373 --

Q161

The colonists searched for gold, and had to find their own sustenance and provide their own sanctuary.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q525) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #374 --

Q162

As food supplies began to run low, and as the colonists faced hunger and disease, they saw that they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q526) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #375 --

Q163

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q527) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #376 --

Q164

A council to make laws for the colony was formed by the settlers.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q528) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #377 --

Q165

Captain John Smith was chosen as president of the council to see that the laws were implemented.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q529) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #378 --

Q166

This government at Jamestown was the first local government in America.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q530) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #379 --

Q167

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q531) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #380 --

Q168

Today, local government is still the first and most important government in our lives.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q532) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #381 --

Q169

It protects our lives, our safety, and our homes, and it helps to keep our environment clean.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q533) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #382 --

Q170

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q534) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #383 --

Q171

Schools, libraries, and other important services are provided to us by local government.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q535) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #384 --

Q172

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 6. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q536) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 14 Passage 6 Questions

-- Screen #385 --

Q173

Passage 6

1. The first colonial government was

- ◯ tribal
- ◯ city
- ◯ county
- ◯ local
- ◯ federal

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q537) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #386 --

Q174

2. The Jamestown colonists formed a government because of

- ◯ pride
- ◯ greed
- ◯ necessity
- ◯ togetherness
- ◯ public spirit

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q538) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #387 --

Q175

3. The best title for this selection would be

- ◯ John Smith
- ◯ The First Government
- ◯ Jamestown
- ◯ Local Government
- ◯ American Government

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q539) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #388 --

Q176

4. The overall goal of local government seems to be public

- ◯ regulation
- ◯ wealth
- ◯ growth
- ◯ welfare
- ◯ protection

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q540) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 15 Passage 7 Easy Booklet 2

-- Screen #389 --

Q178

Passage 7

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q541) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #390 --

Q179

Once in a while you will hear about an artist who was recognized as a master during his lifetime, but was then almost forgotten after his death.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q542) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #391 --

Q180

A good example is the painter, Domenicos Theotocopoulos.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q543) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #392 --

Q181

He was known as El Greco because of his Greek ancestry.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q544) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #393 --

Q182

After pursuing his early career in Italy, El Greco settled in the Spanish city of Toledo, where he prospered for the rest of his life.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q545) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #394 --

Q183

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q546) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #395 --

Q184

He prospered there for the rest of his life.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q547) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #396 --

Q185

History forgot El Greco for nearly three hundred years.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q548) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #397 --

Q186

Then, artists and critics of the twentieth century rediscovered him.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q549) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #398 --

Q187

The power of El Greco's intensely emotional style can be felt most strongly in his later paintings, such as the famous View of Toledo.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q550) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #399 --

Q188

He painted this canvas in 1610, only a few years before his death.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q551) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #400 --

Q189

It is a strange landscape.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q552) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #401 --

Q190

One notices that eerie, silvery buildings take on a ghostlike stillness next to the explosive light of the sky and the writhing forms of the countryside below.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q553) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #402 --

Q191

Curiously, about the same time, another important artist was scorned even by many of his contemporaries.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q554) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #403 --

Q192

This artist was Caravaggio.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q555) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #404 --

Q193

He was a self-taught painter who came to Rome around 1590 from a small town in Lombardy.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q556) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #405 --

Q194

Caravaggio's critics complained that he treated sacred religious subjects in a low, vulgar way by including the faces and figures of common people in his paintings.

Hidden page timer (Q557) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #406 --

Q195

By using stark contrasts of light and shadow, Caravaggio managed to conjure up unforgettable scenes of dramatic realism.

Hidden page timer (Q558) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #407 --

Q196

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q559) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #408 --

Q197

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 7. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

Hidden page timer (Q560) records time spent on this page.

→

Block 16 Passage 7 Questions

-- Screen #409 --

Q198

Passage 7

1. In his paintings, Caravaggio included

- ◯ common people
- ◯ strange landscapes
- ◯ eerie, silvery buildings
- ◯ ghosts
- ◯ corpses

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q561) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #410 --

Q199

2. El Greco pursued his early career in

- ◯ Italy
- ◯ Greece
- ◯ Lombardy
- ◯ Rome
- ◯ Toledo

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q562) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #411 --

Q200

3. Apparently a major technique of Caravaggio's was

- ◯ using exalted religious subjects
- ◯ using stark contrasts
- ◯ using cadavers
- ◯ using ghostlike stillness
- ◯ none of the above

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q563) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #412 --

Q201

4. the principal idea discussed in this passage concerns

- ◯ El Greco
- ◯ Caravaggio
- ◯ Contemporary approval of artists
- ◯ The travels of painters
- ◯ The prosperity of artists

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q564) records time spent on this page.*

→

Block 17 Passage 8 Difficult Booklet 2

-- Screen #413 --

Q203

Passage 8

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q565) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #414 --

Q204

The key to the design called experimental is assignment of subjects to conditions randomly.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q566) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #415 --

Q205

By the influence on the results of some extraneous variable that is tied to or correlated with the variable under investigation is insured against.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q567) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #416 --

Q206

By contrast with experimental designs, subjects, in correlational designs, in a sense, assign themselves to conditions.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q568) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #417 --

Q207

Thus, in the cancer studies as they have been done, only people who are four-pack-a-day smokers—by their own “choice”—get into a four-pack-a-day condition.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q569) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #418 --

Q208

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q570) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #419 --

Q209

Whatever the factors are that contribute to a person's being a heavy smoker surely must also make him different from the typical nonsmoker in other ways.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q571) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #420 --

Q210

Hence the ambiguity of interpretation in correlational designs, and hence the virtue of experimental designs.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q572) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #421 --

Q211

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q573) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #422 --

Q212

In the latter case, if assignment to conditions is truly random then prevailing differences among individual subjects cannot confound the results systematically.

Hidden page timer (Q574) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #423 --

Q213

Put another way, the experimenter has under his control all the variables that can influence the results.

Hidden page timer (Q575) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #424 --

Q214

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q576) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #425 --

Q215

Whether he can exactly identify these variables is another question.

Hidden page timer (Q577) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #426 --

Q216

Thus, entirely unambiguous results are not yielded by experimental designs, merely results that are less ambiguous than those associated with correlational designs.

Hidden page timer (Q578) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #427 --

Q217

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 8. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

Hidden page timer (Q579) records time spent on this page.

→

Block 18 Passage 8 Questions

-- Screen #428 --

Q218

1. Specific mention is made of

- ◯ psychogenesis
- ◯ psychodynamics
- ◯ psychobiology
- ◯ psychotherapy
- ◯ none of the above

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q580) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #429 --

Q219

2. How many research design patterns were discussed?

- ◯ One only
- ◯ Two
- ◯ Three
- ◯ Four
- ◯ Five

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q581) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #430 --

Q220

3. As used in this passage, the phrase "put another way" means

- ◯ rephrasing
- ◯ enumeration
- ◯ using details
- ◯ reasoning
- ◯ illustration

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q582) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #431 --

Q221

4. In this passage the authors imply that heavy smoking is probably caused by

- ◯ tension
- ◯ nervousness
- ◯ habit
- ◯ social pressure
- ◯ all the above and more

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q583) records time spent on this page.*

→

1B Booklet 1: Block “Passage 1 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 1 Questions” + Block “Passage 2 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 2 Questions” + Block “Passage 3 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 3 Questions” + Block “Passage 4 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 4 Questions” + Block “Passage 5 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 5 Questions” + Block “Passage 6 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 6 Questions” + Block “Passage 7 Difficult Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 7 Questions” + Block “Passage 8 Easy Booklet 1” + Block “Passage 8 Questions”

Block 19 Passage 1 Difficult Booklet 1

-- Screen #432 --

Q224

Passage 1

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q584) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #433 --

Q225

A few had been astute enough to see a fine poet in Browning, and Elizabeth Barrett was one of them.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q585) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #434 --

Q226

The young man with the lemon-colored gloves and long dark hair and high-strung, restless manner who had visited her in 1846 had been moved to write to her because she had praised his poetry.

Hidden page timer (Q586) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #435 --

Q227

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q587) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #436 --

Q228

She found the man even more to her liking than the verse, and it was not so very long-only the time between May, 1845 and September, 1846-before Robert Browning had stolen the poetess from the dour father who guarded her like a dragon (never wanting her to marry any man), and taken her with him to Italy and a new life.

Hidden page timer (Q588) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #437 --

Q229

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q589) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #438 --

Q230

One morning, soon after their nuptials, Elizabeth Browning thrust a manuscript into her husband's pocket, and then scampered upstairs in a swift confusion to her room.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q590) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #439 --

Q232

Written during the time of their courtship and love missives, it was a sonnet sequence on their love.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q591) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #440 --

Q233

These poems were never intended by Mrs. Browning to be published, but her poet husband promptly declared that they must be.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q592) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #441 --

Q234

The Sonnets from the Portuguese was his suggested title—a title which might shroud the fact that they were personal.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q593) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #442 --

Q236

They were in his mind “the finest sonnets written in our language since Shakespeare’s.”

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q594) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #443 --

Q237

Sonnets from the Portuguese, in Browning’s opinion, was hardly more flattering to his wife than his opinion of most of her poetry.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q595) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #444 --

Q238

A better poet than he, thought Browning, and the world at that time agreed with him.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q596) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #445 --

Q239

He called her his “moon of poets,” as she considered him her sun.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q597) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #446 --

Q240

She was a pure singer with a lovely lyrical tenderness, the best poet of her sex since Sappho.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q598) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #447 --

Q242

Her Sonnets, in their autobiographical candor, in their fine restraint and fullness, reveal a woman’s secret soul as had no other poetry in our literature up to that time.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q599) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #448 --

Q244

Her lyrical mastery shines in many passages of her writings.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q600) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #449 --

Q245

Italy was a kind of promised terrain for Elizabeth Browning.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q601) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #450 --

Q246

Living in Florence or in little villages in the summers, she drank in the sun of the south and warmth of her husband’s love, and blossomed in a life of precarious happiness for fifteen years.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q602) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #451 --

Q249

In Italy she found friends, most of them cultured Americans.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q603) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #452 --

Q250

Hawthorne saw the Browning's there: the New England thinker and essayist Margaret Fuller visited them.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q604) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #453 --

Q251

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q605) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #454 --

Q252

The painter Story came, and the young sculptress Harriet Hosmer.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q606) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #455 --

Q253

One caller records that Robert Browning was “simple, natural, and playful,” and that Mrs. Browning was all “genius and sensibility.”

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q607) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #456 --

Q254

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q608) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #457 --

Q255

Daytimes Browning walked forth with Elizabeth's little dog Flush, but he seldom could be lured from his home evenings.

Hidden page timer (Q609) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #458 --

Q256

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q610) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #459 --

Q257

One privileged intruder, coming frequently at night to join the poets over hot chestnuts and mulled wine, found talk good and laughter plentiful.

Hidden page timer (Q611) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #460 --

Q258

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q612) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #461 --

Q260

During the third year of their stay in Italy, a son, Robert Weidemann Browning, was born.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q613) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #462 --

Q261

But through this happy life a strain of dark foreboding began to creep.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q614) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #463 --

Q262

Elizabeth Browning's father died unrelenting in his disavowal of her marriage, refusing to see her or to sanction any of his family to see her.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q615) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #464 --

Q264

Three children all younger than her own boy were left to her by a dearly beloved sister who died.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q616) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #465 --

Q265

She drooped and pined a little and Browning shielded her from ordinary visitants.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q617) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #466 --

Q266

She had a sudden and alarming attack of indisposition but was not considered in any precariousness.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q618) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #467 --

Q267

One night, soon after, she awoke from a troubled slumber and, apparently with no idea that she was about to leave him, murmured in the tenderest fashion of her love for him, and in his arms her head drooped as though in a faint, but it was the end.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q619) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #468 --

Q269

Profound and lasting was Browning's grief. “Looking back,” he said, “I see that we have been all the time walking over a torrent on a straw.”

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q620) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #469 --

Q270

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q621) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #470 --

Q271

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 1. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q622) records time spent on this page.*

→

▸ Block “Passage 1 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 4 above).

Block 20 Passage 2 Easy Booklet 1

-- Screen #471 --

Q272

Passage 2

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q623) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #472 --

Q273

Marketing is a business activity that directs the flow of goods and services from a producer to a consumer or user.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q624) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #473 --

Q274

It is the link that connects producers and consumers and brings production and consumption together.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q625) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #474 --

Q276

About one in every six employees is involved directly in wholesaling or retailing activities.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q626) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #475 --

Q277

This ratio does not take into account other employees who assist marketing through transportation, communication, and office jobs.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q627) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #476 --

Q288

Marketing provides many different kinds of jobs.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q628) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #477 --

Q278

These jobs require a wide range of skills and abilities.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q629) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #478 --

Q279

We usually think that the primary job in marketing is selling, but there are jobs in management, advertising, market and product research, and buying.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q630) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #479 --

Q280

The economic well-being of one's country is determined largely by productivity, consumption, and employment.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q631) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #480 --

Q281

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q632) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #481 --

Q282

The efficiency of marketing affects all three.

Hidden page timer (Q633) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #482 --

Q283

People consume many goods if marketing creates a demand.

Hidden page timer (Q634) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #483 --

Q284

High consumption requires high productivity to meet the requirements of people, and high productivity and high-level activity in marketing combined result in high employment.

Hidden page timer (Q635) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #484 --

Q285

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q636) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #485 --

Q286

Marketing is indirectly a key to a high economic level of living for the people.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q637) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #486 --

Q287

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 2. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q638) records time spent on this page.*

→

▸ Block “Passage 2 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 6 above).

Block 21 Passage 3 Difficult Booklet 1

-- Screen #487 --

Q289

Passage 3

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q639) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #488 --

Q290

Atomic energy is the energy that holds the nucleus of an atom together.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q640) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #489 --

Q291

Atomic reactions in which nuclei of helium are built up from nuclei of hydrogen are believed to be the origin of the sun's energy.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q641) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #490 --

Q293

It has been found that the mass of an atomic nucleus is less than the total mass of the separate particles that comprise it.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q642) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #491 --

Q294

The reason is that when a nucleus forms, part of the mass of the component particles is changed into energy, which is then radiated away.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q643) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #492 --

Q296

The quantity of energy released in reactions of this kind is almost inconceivably greater than the quantity released by any other type of reaction involving similar quantities of material.

Hidden page timer (Q644) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #493 --

Q297

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q645) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #494 --

Q298

Every second, a million times as much energy as is stored in all our coal, petroleum, and natural gas fields is sent into space by the sun.

Hidden page timer (Q646) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #495 --

Q299

If one could duplicate the method by which this energy is released, the world could be revolutionized.

Hidden page timer (Q647) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #496 --

Q300

And the possibility of doing just this is no more inconceivable today than the concept of an atomic bomb was in 1900.

Hidden page timer (Q648) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #497 --

Q301

The time may come when the hydrogen from a cubic mile of sea water will provide enough energy to satisfy our needs at the 1960 rate for 300 centuries.

Hidden page timer (Q649) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #498 --

Q302

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q650) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #499 --

Q303

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 3. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

Hidden page timer (Q651) records time spent on this page.

→

Block “Passage 3 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 8 above).

Block 22 Passage 4 Easy Booklet 1

-- Screen #500 --

Q304

Passage 4

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q652) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #501 --

Q305

The possibility of life on Mars is not dismissed even by skeptics.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q653) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #502 --

Q323

They seem to share our hope that it is true.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q655) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #503 --

Q306

So, it was disappointing when scientists studied photos from the early Mariner space flights in the mid-1960's.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q656) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #504 --

Q307

They saw no canals, no seas, and no busy Martian engineers.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q657) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #505 --

Q310

They saw no dangerous, warlike Martians as huge as skyscrapers.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q658) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #506 --

Q311

All they saw were mountains, craters, cold winds, and dust storms.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q659) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #507 --

Q312

It was almost as if scouts for Columbus had returned to Isabella’s court with the news that the world had turned out to be flat after all.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q660) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #508 --

Q313

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q661) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #509 --

Q314

Hopeful astronomers reminded us that the Mariner IV had photographed a mere one percent of the Martian surface from 2,000 miles away.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q662) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #510 --

Q315

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q663) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #511 --

Q324

In addition, the photos were taken from 2,000 miles away.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q664) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #512 --

Q316

And they pointed out that the Earth-orbiting Tiros weather satellite shot over 20,000 pictures before uncovering any evidence of life on Earth.

Hidden page timer (Q665) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #513 --

Q317

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q666) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #514 --

Q318

But still, public enthusiasm for Martian exploration wilted.

Hidden page timer (Q667) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #515 --

Q319

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q668) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #516 --

Q320

Few people seemed to care about life on Mars by the time Viking I landed on the Plain of Chrise in August.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q669) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #517 --

Q321

One Viking scientist, J. Richard Keefe, said that he was “disgusted” at the “blasé...apathetic” public response and the skimpy television coverage of one of the most magnificent scientific and technical accomplishments in human history.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q670) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #518 --

Q322

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 4. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

→

▸ Block “Passage 4 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 10 above).

Block 23 Passage 5 Difficult Booklet 1

-- Screen #519 --

Q325

Passage 5

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q671) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #520 --

Q326

The flavor, odor, and character so highly prized by the gourmet is given to cheese by fungi.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q672) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #521 --

Q327

In caves near the French village of Roquefort was first found one such mold. A peasant boy left his lunch, a mild fresh piece of goat cheese, according to legend, in one of these caverns and on returning found it marbled, tart, and redolent.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q673) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #522 --

Q330

Only cheeses from the area around these particular caves are permitted to bear the name of Roquefort.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q674) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #523 --

Q331

As early as the seventeenth century, ergot, the fungus of rye, was used to facilitate childbirth.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q675) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #524 --

Q332

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q676) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #525 --

Q333

The contraction of the involuntary muscles, particularly of the uterus, is one of its effects.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q677) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #526 --

Q334

In the twentieth century, ergot has once more attracted interest as the source of the chemical from which the hallucinogenic drug LSD is derived.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q678) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #527 --

Q335

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q679) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #528 --

Q336

Most of the modern antibiotics are produced by fungi.

Hidden page timer (Q680) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #529 --

Q337

The first of these was discovered by Alexander Fleming, who noted that a mold of the genus Penicillium which had contaminated a culture of staphylococcus growing on a nutrient agar plate had completely halted the proliferation of the bacteria.

Hidden page timer (Q681) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #530 --

Q340

Antibiotics, of which many hundreds have now been discovered, are substances produced by a living organism that injure another living organism.

Hidden page timer (Q682) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #531 --

Q341

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q683) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #532 --

Q343

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 5. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

Hidden page timer (Q684) records time spent on this page.

→

Block “Passage 5 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 12 above).

Block 24 Passage 6 Easy Booklet 1

-- Screen #533 --

Q344

Passage 6

Hidden page timer (Q685) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #534 --

Q345

Local governments were our first governments.

Hidden page timer (Q686) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #535 --

Q346

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q687) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #536 --

Q347

A local government was established when the oldest men in a primitive tribe formed a council and the tribe chose a chief.

Hidden page timer (Q688) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #537 --

Q348

The tribe was seeking a better, safer life.

Hidden page timer (Q689) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #538 --

Q349

In the same way, the first English settlers soon realized that they needed rules and leaders after they landed at Jamestown, Virginia in 1607.

Hidden page timer (Q690) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #539 --

Q350

At first, the settlers had to look out for themselves.

Hidden page timer (Q691) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #540 --

Q351

They searched for gold, and had to find their own food and provide their own shelter.

Hidden page timer (Q692) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #541 --

Q352

As food supplies began to run low, and as the colonists faced hunger and disease, they saw that they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

Hidden page timer (Q693) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #542 --

Q353

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q694) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #543 --

Q354

So, they needed to work together if the colony was to survive.

Hidden page timer (Q695) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #544 --

Q363

The colonists formed a council to make laws for the colony.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q696) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #545 --

Q355

They chose Captain John Smith as president of the council.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q697) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #546 --

Q364

His job was to see that the laws were carried out.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q698) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #547 --

Q356

This government at Jamestown was the first local government in America.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q699) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #548 --

Q357

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q700) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #549 --

Q358

Today, local government is still the first and most important one in our lives.

Hidden page timer (Q701) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #550 --

Q359

It protects our lives, our safety, and our homes, and it helps to keep our environment clean.

Hidden page timer (Q702) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #551 --

Q360

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q703) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #552 --

Q361

Local government provides us with schools, libraries, and other important services.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q704) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #553 --

Q362

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 6. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q705) records time spent on this page.*

→

▸ Block “Passage 6 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 14 above).

Block 25 Passage 7 Difficult Booklet 1

-- Screen #554 --

Q365

Passage 7

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q706) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #555 --

Q366

Once in a while you will hear about an artist recognized as a master during his own lifetime but then almost forgotten soon after his death.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q707) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #556 --

Q367

A good example is the painter Domenicos Theotocopoulos, known because of his Greek ancestry as El Greco.

Hidden page timer (Q708) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #557 --

Q369

After pursuing his early career in Italy, El Greco settled in the Spanish city of Toledo, where he prospered for the rest of his life.

Hidden page timer (Q709) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #558 --

Q370

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q710) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #559 --

Q371

But after his death, El Greco was forgotten by history for nearly three hundred years, until he was rediscovered by artists and critics of the twentieth century.

Hidden page timer (Q711) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #560 --

Q374

The power of El Greco's intensely emotional style can be felt most strongly in his later canvases, such as the famous View of Toledo painted in 1610, only a few years before death.

Hidden page timer (Q712) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #561 --

Q377

One notices in this strange landscape how the eerie, silvery buildings take on a ghostlike stillness next to the explosive light of the sky and the writhing forms of the countryside below.

Hidden page timer (Q713) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #562 --

Q378

Curiously enough, another important artist of about the same time was scorned even by many of his own contemporaries.

Hidden page timer (Q714) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #563 --

Q379

This artist was Caravaggio, a self-taught painter who had come to Rome around 1590 from a small town in Lombardy.

Hidden page timer (Q715) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #564 --

Q381

Caravaggio's critics complained that he treated exalted religious subjects in a low, vulgar style, because he included in his paintings the faces and figures from the street of common people.

Hidden page timer (Q716) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #565 --

Q382

By using stark contrasts of light and shadow, Caravaggio managed to conjure up unforgettable scenes of dramatic realism.

Hidden page timer (Q717) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #566 --

Q383

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q718) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #567 --

Q384

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 7. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

Hidden page timer (Q719) records time spent on this page.

→

▸ Block “Passage 7 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 16 above).

Block 26 Passage 8 Easy Booklet 1

-- Screen #568 --

Q385

Passage 8

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q720) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #569 --

Q386

Random assignment is the key to experimental design.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q721) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #570 --

Q387

Random assignment insures that the results of experiments are not influenced by some extraneous variable.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q722) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #571 --

Q400

An extraneous variable is one that is correlated with the variable under investigation.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q723) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #572 --

Q388

In contrast, correlational designs allow subjects to assign themselves to conditions.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q724) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #573 --

Q389

Thus, in the cancer studies as they have been done, only people who are four-pack-a-day smokers—by their own “choice”—get into a four-pack-a-day condition.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q725) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #574 --

Q390

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q726) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #575 --

Q391

But, the factors that make people four-pack-a-day smokers must surely make them different from typical nonsmokers in other ways.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q727) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #576 --

Q392

Hence the ambiguity of interpretation in correlational designs, and hence the virtue of experimental designs.

Hidden page timer (Q728) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #577 --

Q393

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Response required.

Hidden page timer (Q729) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #578 --

Q394

Differences among individual subjects cannot systematically confound the results if assignment to conditions is truly random.

Hidden page timer (Q730) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #579 --

Q395

Put another way, the experimenter has under his control all the variables that can influence the results.

Hidden page timer (Q731) records time spent on this page.

→

-- Screen #580 --

Q396

Were you mind wandering when you read the previous sentence?

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

▸ *Response required.*

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q732) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #581 --

Q397

It is another question as to whether they can exactly identify these variables.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q733) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #582 --

Q398

Thus, the results from experimental designs are not entirely unambiguous, but they are less ambiguous than the results from correlational designs

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q734) records time spent on this page.*

→

-- Screen #583 --

Q399

Now you will take the reading comprehension test for passage 8. The questions are in multiple choice format. The test is self-paced.

Click on the arrow to take the test.

▸ *Hidden page timer (Q735) records time spent on this page.*

→

▸ Block “Passage 8 Questions” is shown here again (same content as Block 18 above).

End of random assignment #1

Block 27 Interest Matrix

-- Screen #584 --

Q740

You have finished the reading comprehension test.

Now, please rate your interest level for each of the eight passages that you just read.

	Extremely Uninterested	Moderately Uninterested	Somewhat Uninterested	Neutral or Undecided	Somewhat Interested	Moderately Interested	Extremely Interested
Passage 1. *The Browning Poets*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 2. *Marketing*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 3. *Atomic Energy and the Atomic Bomb*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 4. *Mars and Space*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 5. *Fungi and Antibiotics*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 6. *Jamestown and Government*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 7. *The Artists El Greco and Caravaggio*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Passage 8. *Experimental and Correlational Designs*	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

→

Block 28 End of Experiment

-- Screen #585 --

Q223

End of Experiment

The purpose of this experiment is to assess the effect of mind-wandering on reading difficulty. Some of the passages are difficult to comprehend and some are easy to comprehend. The hypothesis for this experiment is that you will mind-wander more while reading the hard passages relative to the easy passages. Your performance on the reading comprehension test will also go down as you mind-wander. Additionally, you should read relatively slower during the hard condition than the easy condition.

Thank You for Participating!

Q738

Debriefing
Pacific Lutheran University

Title of Study: The effect of mind wandering and text difficulty on reading comprehension: A replication study.

Investigator(s):
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Faculty Supervisor:
Heidi McLaughlin, Psychology Department, mclaughlinh@plu.edu

……

Thank you for your participation in our research study. The purpose of the study is to test the effect of mind wandering and text difficulty on reading comprehension.

We were interested in the topic because past research has shown that mind wandering has influenced areas such as reading comprehension. We expanded on that by doing a replication study that measured mind wandering and reading comprehension while manipulating the variable of text difficulty. We wanted to know if the results of the previous study would be consistent at PLU. We also added the variable of interest in the reading passages to test whether or not interest affects the amount of mind wandering.

We hypothesized that mind wandering would increase while reading the difficult texts, thus causing a decrease in reading comprehension.

The findings of this study will be presented at the 2020 Western Psychological Association Convention in San Francisco.

If you have any questions or concerns please feel free to contact one of us, or our faculty supervisor at the email listed at the top.

If you have any questions or concerns about this study or your rights as a study participant, you may contact the Human Participants Review Board, Pacific Lutheran University through the Provost's Office at (253) 535-7126.

Please do not discuss this study with other potential participants until the semester is over. If people know what we are testing before the study begins, they may respond differently, jeopardizing our results.

Thank you again for your help!

→

▸ End of survey. Participants see the end-of-survey message:

-- Screen #586 --

We thank you for your time spent taking this survey. Your response has been recorded.